

Numerical Problems based on the hardness of water:

Problem-1: A sample of water is found to contains following dissolving salts in milligrams per litre
 $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 73$, $\text{CaCl}_2 = 111$, $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 81$, $\text{MgSO}_4 = 40$ and $\text{MgCl}_2 = 95$. Calculate temporary and permanent hardness and total hardness.

Solution:

Name of the hardness causing salts	Amount of the hardness causing salts(mg/Lit)	Molecular weight of hardness causing salts	Amounts equivalent to CaCO_3 (mg/Lit)
$\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$	73	146	$73 \times 100 / 146 = 50$
CaCl_2	111	111	$111 \times 100 / 111 = 100$
$\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$	81	162	$81 \times 100 / 162 = 50$
MgSO_4	40	120	$40 \times 100 / 120 = 33.3$
MgCl_2	95	95	$95 \times 100 / 95 = 100$

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Temporary hardness} &= \text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 + \text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 \\ &= 50 + 50 = 100\text{mgs/Lit.}\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Permanent hardness} &= \text{CaCl}_2 + \text{MgSO}_4 + \text{MgCl}_2 \\ &= 100 + 33.3 + 100 = 233.3\text{mgs/Lit.}\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Total hardness} &= \text{Temporary hardness} + \text{Permanent hardness} \\ &= 100 + 233.3 = 333.3\text{mgs/Lit.}\end{aligned}$$

Problem-2: A sample of water is found to contains following dissolving salts in milligrams per litre
 $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 16.8$, $\text{MgCl}_2 = 12.0$, $\text{MgSO}_4 = 29.6$ and $\text{NaCl} = 5.0$. Calculate temporary and permanent hardness of water.

Solution:

Name of the hardness causing salts	Amount of the hardness causing salts(mg/Lit)	Molecular weight of hardness causing salts	Amounts equivalent to CaCO_3 (mg/Lit)
$\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$	16.8	146	$16.8 \times 100 / 146 = 11.50$
MgCl_2	12.0	95	$12.0 \times 100 / 95 = 12.63$
MgSO_4	29.6	120	$29.6 \times 100 / 120 = 24.66$
NaCl	5.0	NaCl does not contribute any hardness to water hence it is ignored.	

$$\text{Temporary hardness} = \text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 11.50\text{mgs/Lit.}$$

$$\text{Permanent hardness} = \text{MgCl}_2 + \text{MgSO}_4 = 12.63 + 24.66 = 37.29\text{mgs/Lit.}$$

Problem-3: A sample of water is found to contains following analytical data in milligrams per litre
 $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 14.6$, $\text{MgCl}_2 = 9.5$, $\text{MgSO}_4 = 6.0$ and $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 16.2$. Calculate temporary and permanent hardness of water in parts per million, Degree Clarke's and Degree French.

Solution:

Name of the hardness causing salts	Amount of the hardness causing salts(mg/Lit)	Molecular weight of hardness causing salts	Amounts equivalent to CaCO_3 (mg/Lit)
$\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$	14.6	146	$14.6 \times 100 / 146 = 10$
MgCl_2	9.5	95	$9.5 \times 100 / 95 = 10$
MgSO_4	6.0	120	$6.0 \times 100 / 120 = 5$
$\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$	16.2	162	$16.2 \times 100 / 162 = 10$

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Temporary hardness } [\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 + \text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2] &= 10 + 10 = 20\text{mg/Lit} \\ &= 20\text{ppm} \\ &= 20 \times 0.07^\circ\text{Cl} = 1.4^\circ\text{Cl} \\ &= 20 \times 0.1^\circ\text{Fr} = 2^\circ\text{Fr}\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Permanent hardness } [\text{MgCl}_2 + \text{MgSO}_4] &= 10 + 5 = 15\text{mg/Lit} \\ &= 15\text{ppm} \\ &= 15 \times 0.07^\circ\text{Cl} = 1.05^\circ\text{Cl} \\ &= 15 \times 0.1^\circ\text{Fr} = 1.5^\circ\text{Fr}\end{aligned}$$

Problem-4: Calculate the amount of temporary and permanent hardness of a water sample in Degree Clarke's, Degree French and Milligrams per Litre which contains following impurities.

$\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 121.5$ ppm, $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 116.8$ ppm, $\text{MgCl}_2 = 79.6$ ppm and $\text{CaSO}_4 = 102$ ppm.

Solution:

Name of the hardness causing salts	Amount of the hardness causing salts(ppm)	Molecular weight of hardness causing salts	Amounts equivalent to CaCO_3 (ppm)
$\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$	121.5	162	$121.5 \times 100 / 162 = 75$
$\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$	116.8	146	$116.8 \times 100 / 146 = 80$
MgCl_2	79.6	95	$79.6 \times 100 / 95 = 3.37$
CaSO_4	102	136	$102 \times 100 / 136 = 75$

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Temporary hardness } [\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 + \text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2] &= 75 + 80 = 155 \text{ ppm} \\ &= 155 \times 0.07^\circ\text{Cl} = 10.85^\circ\text{Cl} \\ &= 155 \times 0.1^\circ\text{Fr} = 15.5^\circ\text{Fr} \\ &= 155 \times 1\text{mg/Lit} = 155 \text{ mg/Lit}\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Permanent hardness } [\text{MgCl}_2 + \text{CaSO}_4] &= 10 + 5 = 15\text{mg/Lit} \\ &= 15\text{ppm} \\ &= 15 \times 0.07^\circ\text{Cl} = 1.05^\circ\text{Cl} \\ &= 15 \times 0.1^\circ\text{Fr} = 1.5^\circ\text{Fr}\end{aligned}$$

Problem-5: Calculate the temporary and permanent hardness of water sample containing $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 7.3\text{mg/L}$, $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 16.2\text{mg/L}$, $\text{MgCl}_2 = 9.5\text{mg/L}$, $\text{CaSO}_4 = 13.6\text{mg/L}$.

Solution: conversion into CaCO_3 equivalents:

Constituent	Multiplication factor	CaCO_3 equivalent
$\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 7.3\text{mg/L}$	100/146	$7.3 \times 100 / 146 = 5\text{mg/L}$
$\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 16.2\text{mg/L}$	100/162	$16.2 \times 100 / 162 = 10\text{mg/L}$
$\text{MgCl}_2 = 9.5\text{mg/L}$	100/95	$9.5 \times 100 / 95 = 10\text{mg/L}$
$\text{CaSO}_4 = 13.6\text{mg/L}$	100/136	$13.6 \times 100 / 136 = 10\text{mg/L}$

$$\begin{aligned}\therefore \text{Temporary hardness of water due to } \text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 \text{ and } \text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 &= \\ &= 5 + 10 = 15\text{mg/L or } 15\text{ppm}.\end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Permanent hardness due to } \text{MgCl}_2 \text{ and } \text{CaSO}_4 = 10 + 10 = 20\text{mg/L or } 20\text{ppm}.$$

Problem-6: Calculate the temporary and total hardness of a water sample containing $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 73\text{mg/L}$, $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 162\text{mg/L}$, $\text{MgCl}_2 = 95\text{mg/L}$, $\text{CaSO}_4 = 136\text{mg/L}$.

Solution: calculation of CaCO_3 equivalents:

Constituent	Multiplication factor	CaCO_3 equivalent
$\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 73\text{mg/L}$	$100/146$	$73 \times 100/146 = 50\text{mg/L}$
$\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 162\text{mg/L}$	$100/162$	$162 \times 100/162 = 100\text{mg/L}$
$\text{MgCl}_2 = 95\text{mg/L}$	$100/95$	$95 \times 100/95 = 100\text{mg/L}$
$\text{CaSO}_4 = 136\text{mg/L}$	$100/136$	$136 \times 100/136 = 100\text{mg/L}$

$\therefore$ Temporary hardness of water due to $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$ and $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 =$

$$= 100 + 50 = 150\text{mg/L or ppm.}$$

Total hardness of water = $50 + 100 + 100 + 100 = 350\text{ mg/L or ppm.}$

Exercises for Practice:

1. A sample of water contains 18 mg/L of $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$, 17 mg/L of CaSO_4 , 12 mg/L of CaCl_2 , 14 mg/L of $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$, and 14 mg/L of MgCl_2 . Calculate temporary, permanent and total hardness in terms of CaCO_3 equivalent. Given molecular weight $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 162$, $\text{CaSO}_4 = 136$, $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 146$, $\text{MgCl}_2 = 95$.
2. A sample of water contains 22 mg/L of $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$, 17 mg/L of CaSO_4 , 11 mg/L of CaCl_2 , 32 mg/L of $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$, and 21 mg/L of MgCl_2 . Calculate temporary, permanent and total hardness in terms of CaCO_3 equivalent. Given molecular weight $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 162$, $\text{CaSO}_4 = 136$, $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 146$, $\text{MgCl}_2 = 95$.
3. A sample of water contains 20 mg/L of $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$, 16 mg/L of CaSO_4 , 12 mg/L of CaCl_2 , 11 mg/L of $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$, and 21 mg/L of MgCl_2 . Calculate temporary, permanent and total hardness in terms of CaCO_3 equivalent. Given molecular weight $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 162$, $\text{CaSO}_4 = 136$, $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2 = 146$, $\text{MgCl}_2 = 95$.
4. A sample of water contains 20 mg/L of $\text{Ca}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$, 30 mg/L of CaSO_4 , 12 mg/L of CaCl_2 , 14 mg/L of $\text{Mg}(\text{HCO}_3)_2$, and 56 mg/L of MgCl_2 . Calculate temporary, permanent and total hardness in terms of CaCO_3 equivalent.
